

BUMPS

Psalm 37

(I will not be reading a text)

What happens when someone bumps into you? (Illustrate this with a glass of water)

Many years ago a dear friend of ours made the following statement as she testified about the goodness of God. She said, "*The path of life is bump bump, glory glory, bump.*"

When we hit a bump on the road of life, whatever is closest to the surface is what comes sloshing out:

- Anger...
- Fear...
- Rejection...
- Peace...

- Joy...
- Love...

In [Psalm 37:1](#) David had obviously been bumped (Thumped) by an evil person. ***“Do not fret because of evildoers, Nor be envious of the workers of iniquity.”***

Their plot against him had met with success. [Psalm 37:12 \(NKJV\)](#) ***“The wicked plots against the just, And gnashes at him with his teeth.”***

David floundered while the wicked flourished. [Psalm 37:24 \(NKJV\)](#) ***“Though he fall (The righteous), he shall not be utterly cast down; For the Lord upholds him with His hand.”*** [Psalm 37:35 \(NKJV\)](#) ***“I have seen the wicked in great power, And spreading himself like a native green tree.”***

To me, the thing that jumps off the pages of Psalm 37 is, at a most difficult intersection of life he gushed forth statements of trust in the Lord! I am sure his uplifting self-talk served to stabilize his own spirit. The same is true of us. We are positioned for victory or set up to fail by the words of our mouth. Proverbs 18:21 (NKJV) *“Death and life are in the power of the tongue...”* (Oh be careful little mouth what you say)

This Psalm teaches us what to avoid, and what to embrace when the potholes and bumps of life threaten our sanity and destiny.

WHAT TO AVOID

1. Avoid Fretting - Three times we are told, *“Do not fret.”* (Vs. 1,7,8) In other words, Don't get over heated. We should guard against allowing our passions to overwhelm us. This is easier said than done. Yet, the very first priority this psalm lays for us is to

rein in our galloping and out-of-control reactions.

2. Avoid Envy - First of all envy is a sin. Envy never takes into consideration the difficulties another has endured to be where they are. Envy is an attempt by the enemy to place us on a life path God never intended for us. Envy is a detour that features a fatal trap. (Bridge out)

For the Christian, envy is the worst case scenario because those who do wrong are like grass that soon withers, and green plants that soon die away. [Psalm 37:2 \(NKJV\)](#)

“For they shall soon be cut down like the grass, And wither as the green herb.”

The last thirty verses of Psalm 37 deals with this theme (vv. 11-40), contrasting the ultimate end of the righteous and the wicked. The Lord instructs us not to look with envy upon the temporary prosperity of

those who do wrong because, "*The future of the wicked will be cut off.*" (Vs. 38)

3. Avoid Vengefulness - When we are wronged, the natural reaction is to get even. The Lord knows how painful it is to be hurt, but He requires that we abstain from anger and turn from wrath. Psalm 37:8 (NKJV) "*Cease from anger, and forsake wrath; Do not fret—it only causes harm.*" It is not our task to exact vengeance. Romans 12:19 (NKJV) "*Vengeance is Mine, I will repay,*" *says the Lord.*"

The more I boil, fret, and stew, the more I bumble into evil and become ensnared by it.

WHAT TO EMBRACE

Though life has a way of placing enormous bumps and potholes in our pathway, this psalm gives us balance in for those difficult jolts. A godly response to difficult or hurtful

situations requires positive actions on our part. When we hit a bump, we should:

1. Embrace trust – Psalm 37:3 (NKJV)

“Trust in the Lord, and do good; Dwell in the land, and feed on His faithfulness.”

Bumps and potholes tend to erode our trust. The hit on trust often manifests itself toward people but let's be honest, it also causes us to place a question mark with regard on what we believe God is doing on our behalf.

I trust the Lord, theologically but I struggle practically when the bump has rattled my teeth. During these times I must not allow my trust to be eroded in God or man.

2. Embrace good deeds - Psalm 37:3

(NKJV) ***“Trust in the Lord, and do good; Dwell in the land, and feed on His faithfulness.”*** Please note: There is a comma after ***“Trust in the Lord”***, not a period. The thought of trusting God is one

and the same with doing good in difficult times.

The implication is clear: Verbalizing faith in the Lord must be accompanied by right actions, in spite of difficult times.

3. Embrace delight – Psalm 37:4 (NKJV)
***“Delight yourself also in the Lord,
And He shall give you the desires of your heart.”*** The Hebrew word here is pronounced *aw-nag* and means “*to be dependent upon God and to derive one’s pleasure from Him.*”

The Psalmist lets know we have good reason to delight in the Lord in difficult times:

- Verse 23 lets us know that God delights in us...
- Verses 11, and 22 reminds us that He causes the meek (those who are wholly dependent on Him) to inherit the land...

- Verse 18 Say's He will give us an enduring inheritance...
- Verse 24 say's he upholds us when we stumble so we do not fall...
- Verses 25, and 28 tells us that He will never leave us or allow us to be defeated...
- Verses 37-40 says He holds for us a glorious future...

4. Commit your way to the Lord – **Psalm 37:5 (NKJV) “Commit your way to the Lord, Trust also in Him...”** Oswald Chambers said *“We often attempt to think rather than obey our way out of confusion.”* If I do what the Lord asks even when I don't know where He is leading me, then I can be assured of safely emerge from the rough spot.

5. Be still – **Psalm 37:7 (NKJV) “Rest in the Lord, and wait patiently for Him...”** I don't like to wait. I want my appointments to

be on time. It doesn't always happen that way, sometimes others cause the schedule to go into the ditch and sometimes I am the culprit.

I have also learned that God does not operate on my time schedule.

CONCLUSION:

The bumps in life reveal what's in us. (Use glass of water again to illustrate this) (If the cuss weren't in there it would not have come out)